Joko: where the cashback offer wins, and what it means for the US push

Public-data analysis of Joko's merchant offer, competitive position and user feedback, with an AI layer that lets non-technical teams ask the data directly.

PUBLIC · PAGES 1, 3

3.2x

more App Store ratings in France than the next cashback app: Joko is the largest public footprint

PUBLIC · PAGE 3

+1.0 pt

median rate gap for the same merchant between two French platforms (316 merchants): rates are not a moat

PUBLIC · PAGE 4

0.5%

Joko's US App Store ratings as a share of Rakuten's: the US push starts from a small, fast-growing base

SIMULATED + AI · PAGE 8

28/28

questions answered or refused correctly by the read-only data assistant, 0 invented numbers

Business questions

1 · Company Where does Joko stand today, in public data?

2-3 · Offer What does the French cashback market pay, and how different are platforms?

4 · US What does the US push start from?

5-6 · Users & dynamics What do users praise and complain about? How do offers move?

7-8 · The job Which metrics, which model, and how can teams ask the data safely with AI?

Recommendations: make *time-to-first-validated-cashback* a top-level metric next to activation; protect the moments users complain about (connecting a bank or the extension, first withdrawal); compete on automation and the assistant rather than on rates; measure Juno with a randomised rollout, not with adopter vs non-adopter comparisons; give teams one semantic layer and an AI assistant that shows its SQL and cannot invent numbers.

Data & methods

PUBLIC DATA Widilo & iGraal rates (674 merchants, 316 compared), App Store & Firefox reviews and ratings, Wayback archives, Google Trends, press releases. Joko's in-app rates are not public and were not collected.

SIMULATED 30,000 users on real merchants and public rates (seed 42), for metrics, model and AI demo only.

SQL DuckDB, semantic layer + 7 queries · **Python** bootstrap, Wilcoxon, logistic regression with time hold-out · **AI** low-cost LLM via API: review themes (human-checked) and guarded text-to-SQL with an evaluation set.

How to read this report

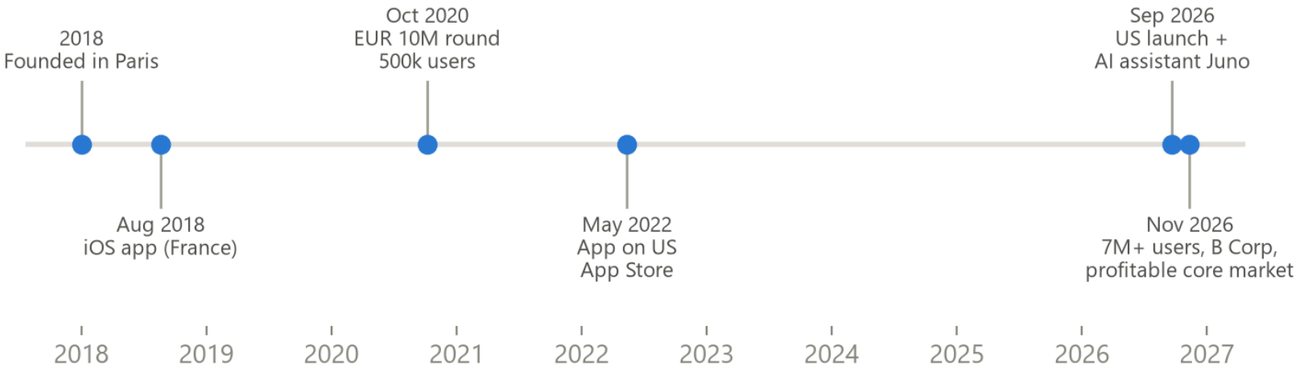
Titles state the conclusion · **Tags** PUBLIC DATA / SIMULATED / + AI say where the data comes from · **Blue** = Joko or the focus, **grey** = comparison, **red** = alert, **dashed** = threshold or reference · **Code**: SQL, notebook and AI scripts in the repository.

Joko grew from 500k users (2020) to 7M+ (2026): the largest App Store base among French cashback apps, with search interest up 3x since 2022

PUBLIC DATA

Company milestones from primary sources, the user numbers Joko itself published, and Google search interest. On the App Store, Joko has 80,270 ratings in France, 3.2x the next French cashback app.

Milestones (primary sources)

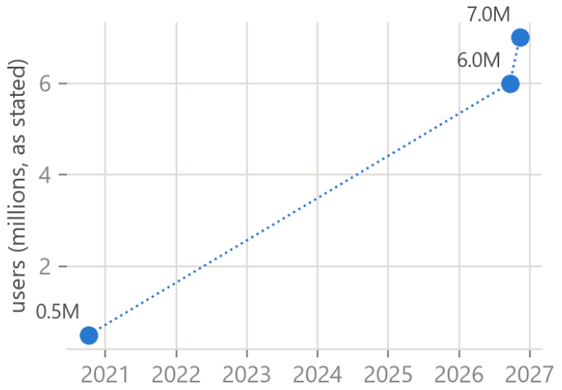


PUBLIC · JOB POSTING 2026

7M+

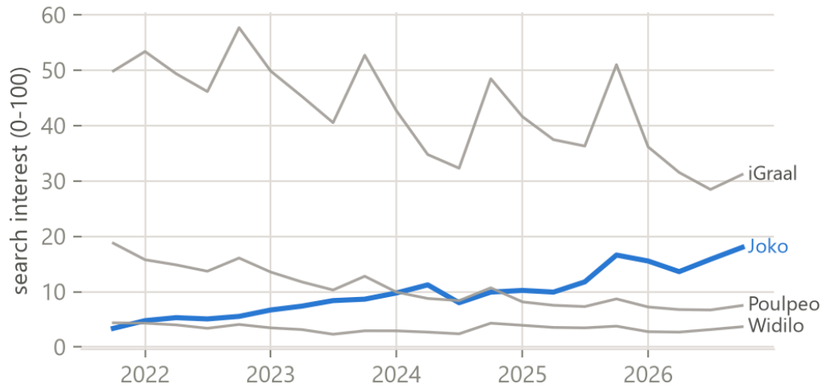
users and 10,000+ merchants; B Corp; 120+ people in Paris, Barcelona, New York

Users, as published by Joko



500k (Oct 2020 funding release) → 6M (Sept 2026 US launch release) → 7M+ (Nov 2026 job posting).

Google search interest, France, 5 years



Last 12 months, France, average interest: iGraal 36, Joko 16, Poulpeo 7, Widilo 3. Quarterly averages of weekly values.

PUBLIC · APP STORE FRANCE

80k

ratings, average 4.72/5 — 3.2x the next French cashback app (iGraal)

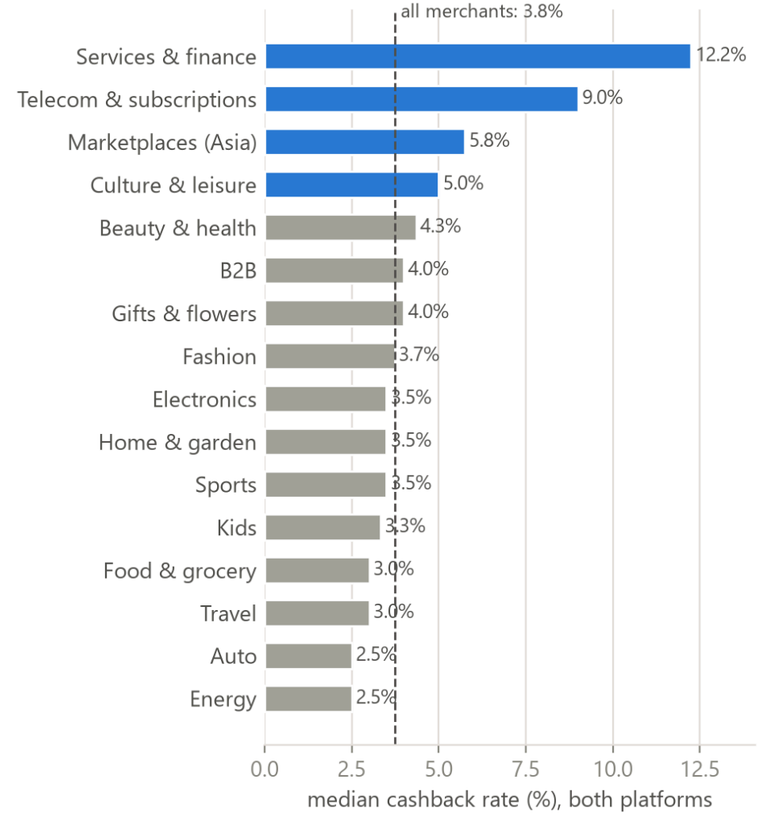
Sources: Partech release (Oct 2020), PR Newswire (Sept 2026), Joko job posting & homepage (Nov 2026), iTunes Search API, Google Trends; collected 2026-11-11 · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Joko

The French market pays a median 3.8% cashback (up to 12% in services & finance); 1 offer in 6 is boosted and confirmation takes ~2 months

PUBLIC DATA

Market benchmark from 674 merchants listed on Widilo and iGraal (France, snapshot of 11 Nov 2026). Joko's own rates are only visible inside its app, so this page describes the market Joko competes in, not Joko's offer.

Median cashback rate by category (percentage offers)



Blue = top fifth of categories. Dashed = median of all percentage offers. 10% of offers are a fixed amount (EUR), mostly subscriptions, energy and finance.

PUBLIC · WIDILO + IGRAAL

16%

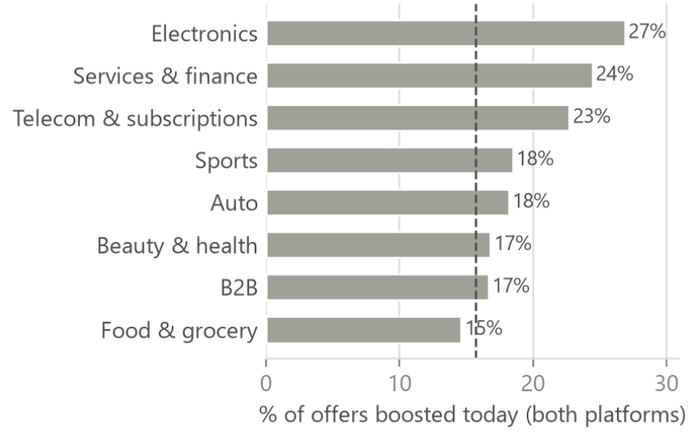
of offers carry a temporary boost; the median boost multiplies the usual rate by 2.2

PUBLIC · WIDILO

2 months

median announced delay before cashback is confirmed; 77% of merchants announce more than 60 days

Boosted offers by category (8 most boosted, 20+ offers)



Dashed = all offers. By platform: Widilo 17%, iGraal 14%. A boost is flagged by the platform itself (au lieu de X%).

What it means for a cashback app

Services & finance and other high-rate categories carry the largest commissions, but also the longest and most uncertain confirmations.

Boosts are a standard acquisition tool: about one offer in 6 is boosted on any given day.

The ~2-month wait is structural (merchants' return periods). It is not the main complaint in the reviews visible today (page 5), but it is the obvious hypothesis for early churn: page 7 shows how to measure it.

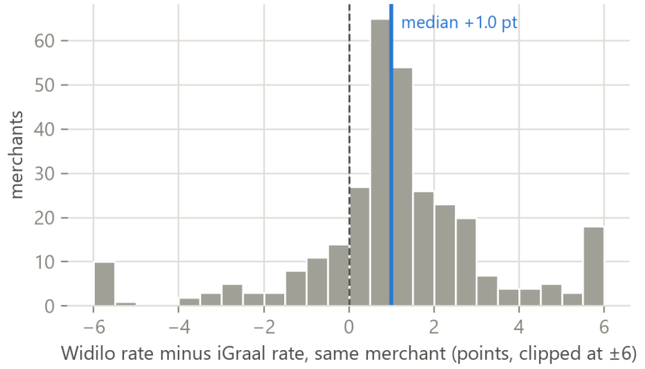
Sources: widilo.fr category pages (93), fr.igraal.com merchant pages (411); collected 2026-11-11; see data/SOURCES.md · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Joko

For the same merchant, two French platforms pay rates ~1 point apart: the rate is a thin edge, while Joko leads on scale

PUBLIC DATA

316 merchants with a percentage rate on both Widilo and iGraal the same day. Median gap +1.0 pt (95% CI 0.75 to 1.00; Wilcoxon p < 0.001), i.e. a relative gap of about 25%. Joko is not in the rate comparison (its rates are not public); its public footprint is shown on the right.

Distribution of the rate gap



Widilo's category pages showcase its most promoted merchants, so its premium is an upper bound.

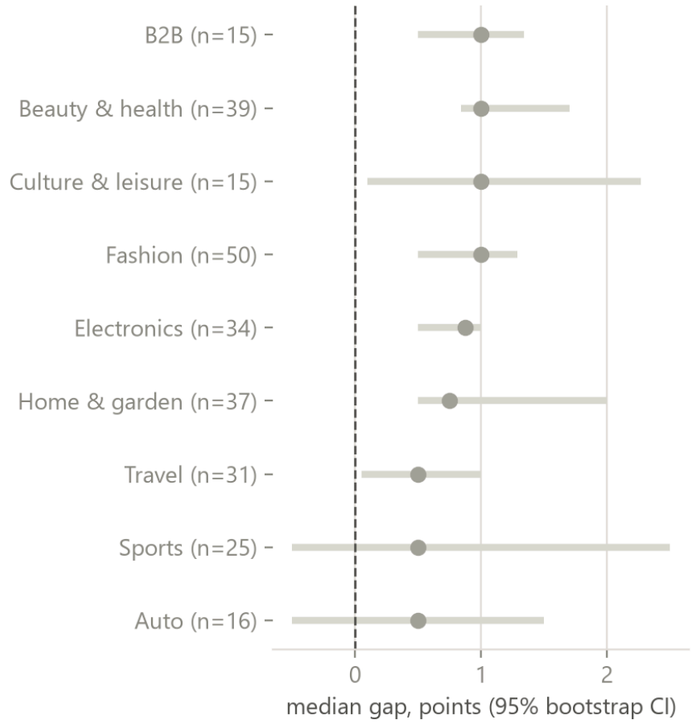
PUBLIC · 316 MERCHANTS

76%

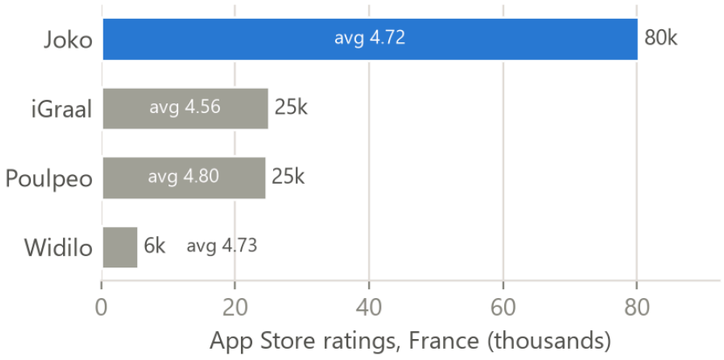
of shared merchants pay more on the challenger (Widilo); 5% tie; 19% pay more on the incumbent (iGraal)



Gap by category (categories with 15+ merchants)



Public footprint: App Store ratings, France



Ratings count = a proxy for installed base and engagement, not market share. avg = average rating out of 5.

Reading for Joko

Rates are a thin edge: on most shared merchants one platform pays about a point more than the other, and boosts move rates from week to week (page 6). Competing on rate alone is costly.

Joko's public advantages are elsewhere: by far the largest rated user base, automatic cashback through card-linked offers, automatic coupons and an AI assistant. **The data question is which of these drives retention** (pages 7-8).

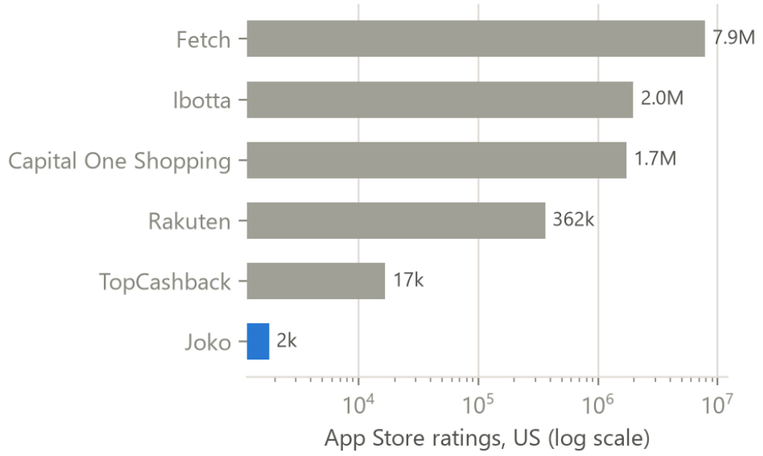
Sources: widilo.fr and fr.igraal.com public pages, iTunes Search API; collected 2026-11-11. Test: notebooks/analysis.ipynb · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Joko

Joko's US App Store base grew ~10x since mid-2025 but is still 0.5% of Rakuten's: the US push needs a wedge, not a rate war

PUBLIC DATA

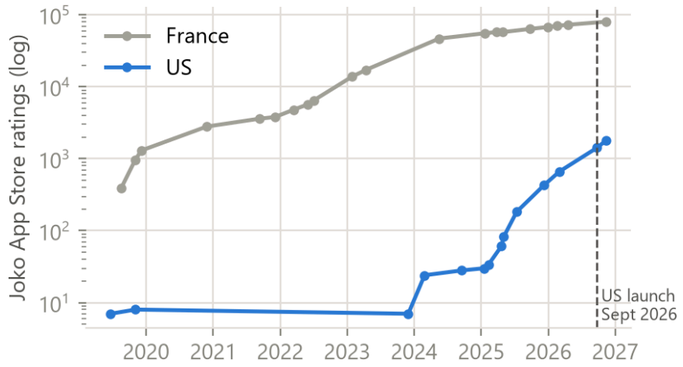
Joko has been on the US App Store since May 2022 and launched officially in Sept 2026 with Juno. Today: 1,788 US ratings (avg 4.76) vs 362k for Rakuten and millions for Ibotta, Fetch and Capital One Shopping.
US competitors' terms forbid automated collection of their rates, so no rate comparison is made.

US App Store ratings: Joko vs established apps



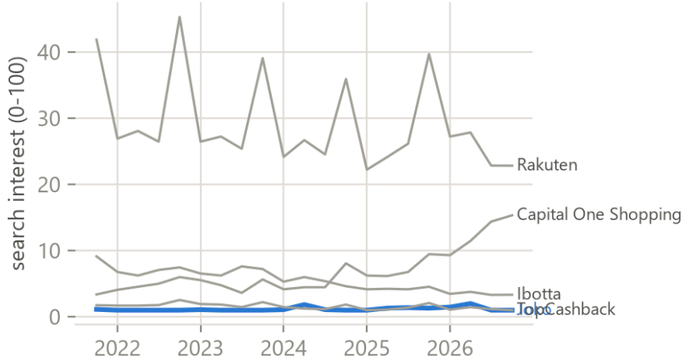
Blue = Joko. Ratings count is a footprint proxy, not users.

Joko's App Store ratings over time



Each point = one archived copy of Joko's App Store page (Wayback Machine) or today's page.

Google search interest, US, 5 years



"Joko" is also a common word/name: the US series is an upper bound for the app.

Fact-based recommendations for the US push

- **Measure the wedge, not the rate.** US incumbents already pay high, well-known rates; Joko's differentiator is the AI assistant + automatic cashback. Track Juno-assisted purchases as a first-class metric.
- **Instrument the first 30 days.** With a small base, every early user counts: report activation and time-to-first-validated-cashback by acquisition channel weekly (metrics on page 7).
- **Protect the payout moment.** The worst US reviews are about withdrawals blocked for "suspicious activity" (page 5): track the share of first withdrawals put on hold and the time to resolve them.
- **Ratings as an early signal.** Watch the US rating count and 1-star share monthly against the French trajectory (same app, same metric).

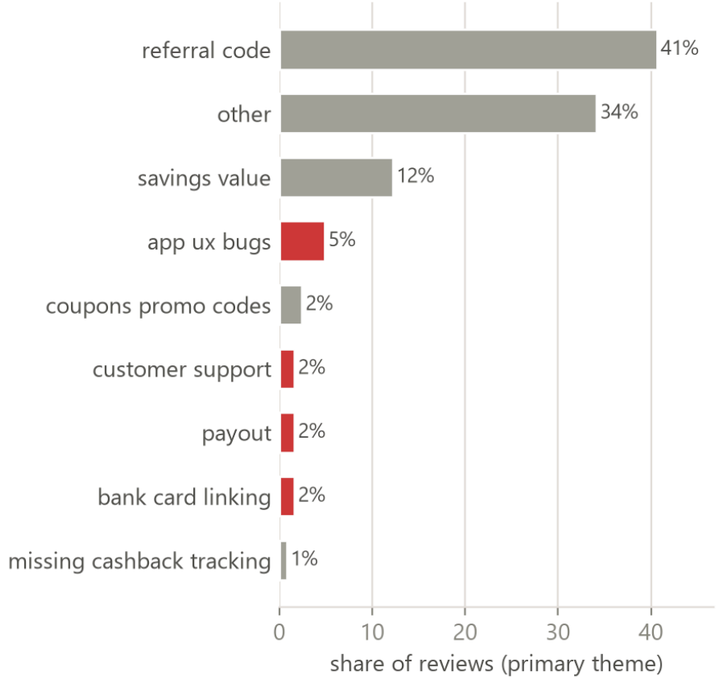
Sources: iTunes Search API, Wayback Machine (apps.apple.com), Google Trends, PR Newswire (21 Sept 2026); collected 2026-11-11 · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Joko

Reviews praise effortless savings; the 1-2 star ones are about getting connected and getting paid, and 41% of visible reviews are referral-code posts

PUBLIC + AI

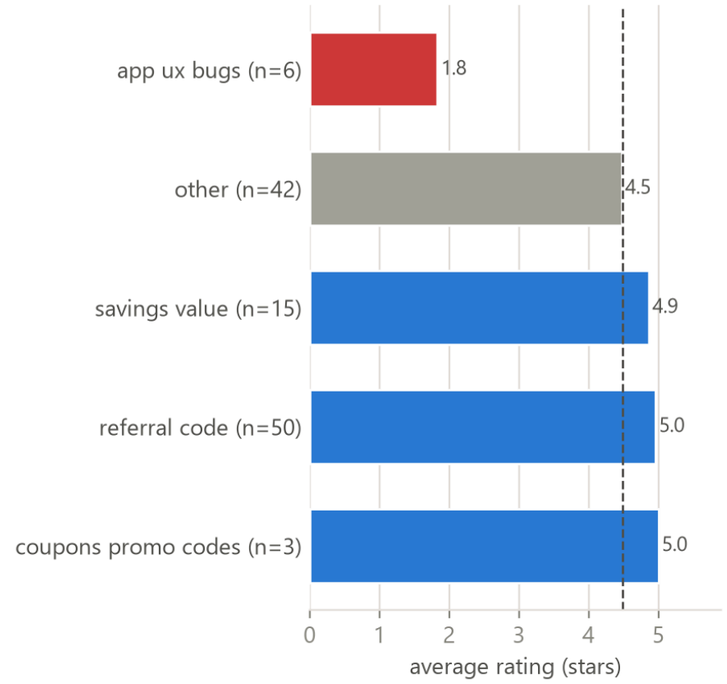
123 public reviews (App Store France/US incl. archived pages 2019-2026, Firefox add-on), classified by an AI model into a closed list of themes and checked by hand on 100. Connection, payout, bug and support reviews average 2.2 stars vs 4.8 for the rest. The expected 'cashback validation delay' complaint barely appears. Small, non-random sample: read as themes, not as rates.

What reviews talk about



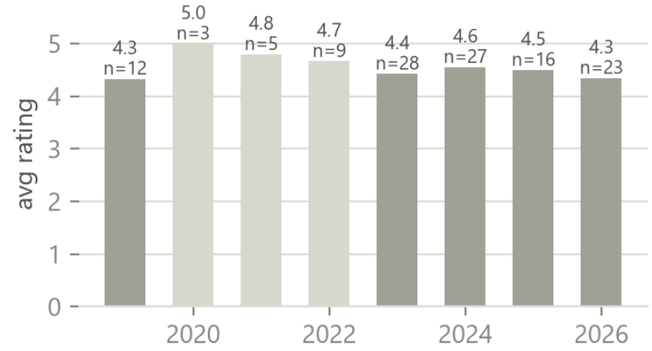
Red = themes where most reviews are 1-2 stars. Referral-code posts are almost all 5 stars: incentivised reviews lift the visible average.

Average rating by theme (themes with 3+ reviews)



Dashed = all reviews (4.49 stars). Red below 3, blue 4.5 and above.

Rating by year (with number of reviews)



Pale bars: fewer than 10 reviews, not interpreted.

Classification quality (human check)

81%

of 100 reviews: AI primary theme = human label (keyword baseline: 64%)

theme (n ≥ 3)	n	precision
referral code	41	66%
other	33	100%
savings value	11	91%
app ux bugs	6	100%

100 reviews drawn at random (seed 42) and labelled by hand with the AI label visible (not blind). Most disagreements: long reviews ending with a referral code (AI: referral_code; human: main subject).

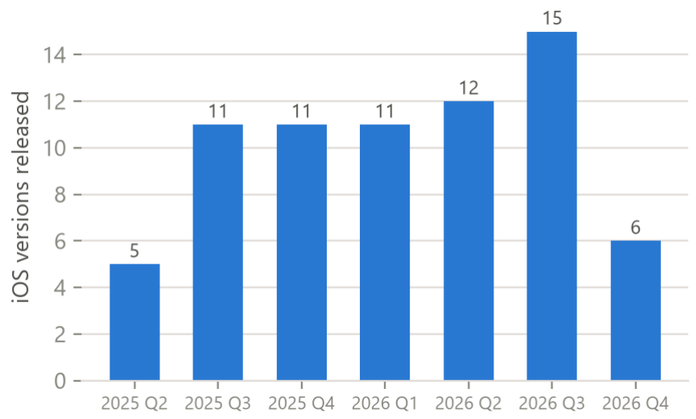
Sources: apps.apple.com (live + Wayback Machine), addons.mozilla.org API; reviewer names never collected, referral codes masked. Model: low-cost LLM via API, closed theme list, JSON schema · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Joko

Joko ships an iOS update every 7 days and keeps adding ~13k French ratings a year; rival offers move through short boosts of x2.2

PUBLIC DATA

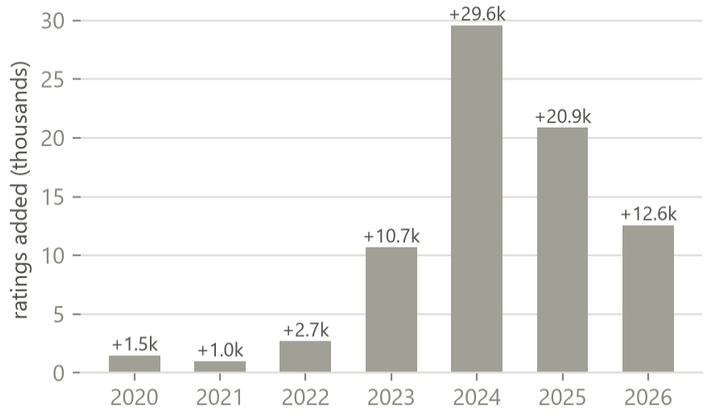
71 iOS versions released between May 2025 and Nov 2026 (App Store version history, incl. archived copies). Ratings growth from archived App Store pages. Boosts from today's Widilo and iGraal snapshot (161 boosted offers with a published usual rate). A planned history of competitor rates was stopped when archive.org rate-limited the collection.

Joko iOS releases per quarter



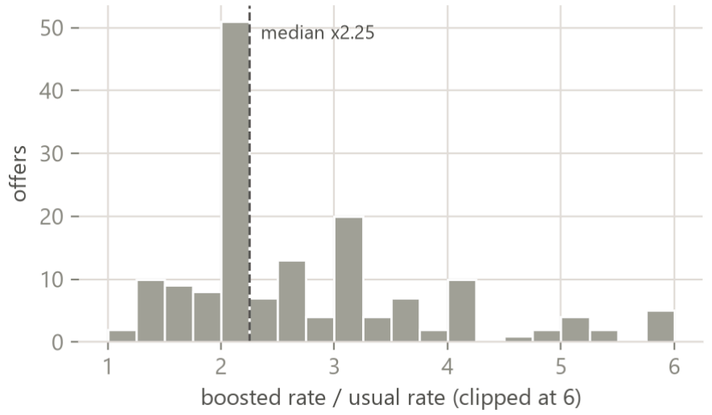
Median gap between two releases: 7 days. The current quarter is not complete.

French App Store ratings added per year



Difference between the last archived counts of two years (snapshots are irregular). The 2023-2024 jump is the largest.

How big are boosts? (France, today)



A boost usually doubles the rate for a few days: a strong lever for a cashback app's acquisition calendar.

What Joko's homepage said, over time

Public claim (archived homepage)	Value	When
French homepage: brands shown	**3,500**	first seen Nov 2025
English homepage: brands shown	**7,500**	first seen Jan 2026
Juno / AI assistant on the homepage	**yes**	first seen Aug 2026

37 archived homepages checked (max 1 per quarter, 2022-2026). Before 2026 the homepage is rendered by JavaScript and its archived copies contain no readable text. The 2026 press release and job posting mention 10,000+ merchants: definitions differ (brands shown vs all partners).

What a data team would monitor

- **Release impact**: with a weekly release, tie every release to rating, crash and conversion changes (before/after with a control period).
- **Boost calendar**: competitors' boosts on the same merchants (sales, Black Friday) vs Joko's clicks and conversions.
- **Catalogue coverage**: share of users' spend that lands on merchants with an active offer.

Sources: App Store version history (apps.apple.com, incl. Wayback Machine copies), Widilo and iGraal pages, Joko homepages (Wayback); collected 2026-11-11 · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Joko

Activation is the lever: activated users retain 60% at day 90 vs 24%, and 14 days of behaviour predict who stays (AUC 0.75)

SIMULATED

SIMULATED data (30,000 users, 18 months, seed 42) built on the real merchants and public rates. A 14-day logistic model predicts D90 retention on later sign-ups with AUC 0.75 (time hold-out, 10,512 users) and is well calibrated.

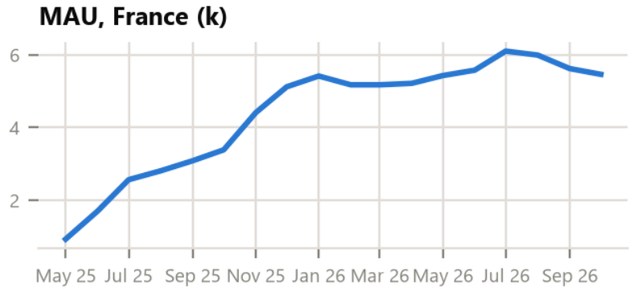
Proposed metric definitions

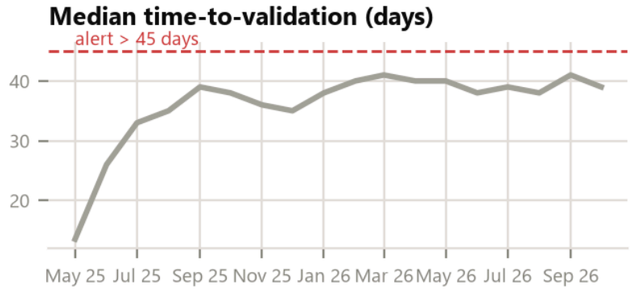
Metric	Definition (METRICS.md)
Activated user	≥ 1 non-cancelled tracked purchase within 30 days of signup
Validated cashback	cashback of purchases confirmed by the merchant (excludes pending, cancelled)
Time-to-validation	days from purchase to merchant confirmation; median per month
D90 retention	≥ 1 session between day 61 and day 90 after signup
Cashback cost / active user	validated cashback of the month / MAU

One definition per metric, written once in SQL and reused everywhere.

Self-service dashboard (mock-up on simulated data)

MAU (Oct)	Activation	D90 retention	Cashback / MAU
5,463	39%	39%	€3.23





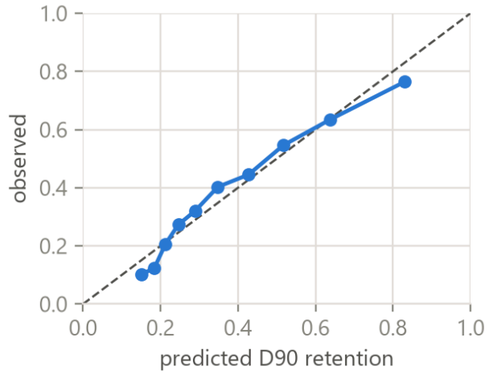
Filters in one row: country · channel · platform · signup month. Built on the semantic views (sql/00_semantic_layer.sql) so every team reads the same definitions.

SIMULATED · HOLD-OUT

AUC 0.75

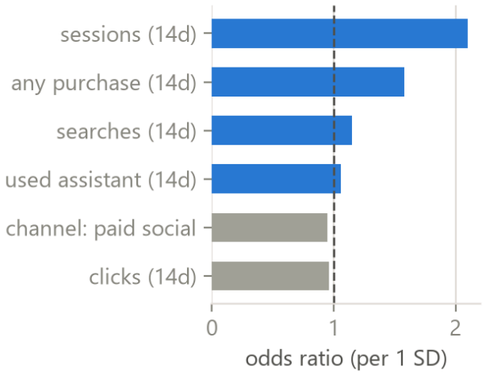
14-day behaviour → D90 retention. Base rate 38%. Users with a purchase in 14 days: 63% retained vs 29%.

Calibration on the hold-out (10 groups)



On the dashed line = predicted probabilities can be read as rates.

Strongest signals (odds ratio per SD)



Associations, not causes: use the score to target onboarding, then A/B test the action.

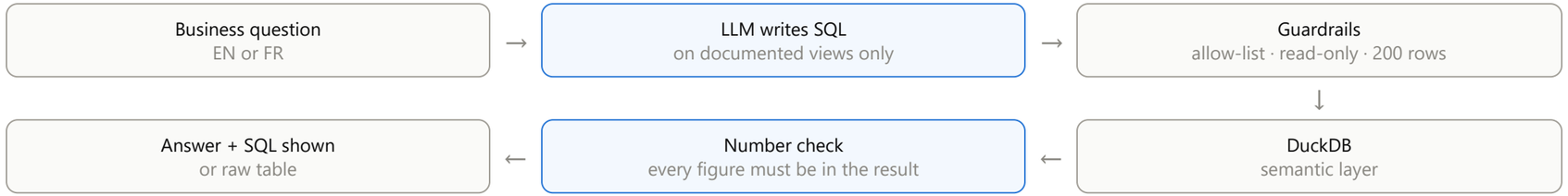
SIMULATED data: src/simulate.py (assumptions in data/ASSUMPTIONS.md). Model: notebooks/analysis.ipynb. Not Joko data · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Joko

"Ask the data": 28/28 questions answered or refused correctly, 0 invented numbers, for $0.0002 per question

SIMULATED + AI

A read-only assistant that lets non-technical teams query the metrics of page 7 in plain English or French. The model only sees a documented semantic layer; every number it writes is checked against the SQL result. SIMULATED data, so the evaluation measures the method.

How it works



Results

Evaluation (fixed set, known answers)	Result
Correct answers, in scope	**24/24**
Out-of-scope questions refused	**4/4**
Invented numbers in answers	**0**
Guardrail unit tests (SQL that must be blocked)	7/7
Average cost per question	$0.00024
Median latency	2.5 s

Questions written with their SQL answer before running the model (eval/questions.yaml); one run; easy-to-medium questions.

Guardrails

- **Scope**: refuses questions the views cannot answer (real Joko users, competitors, personal data, writes).
- **Allow-list**: only the 3 semantic views; file functions, writes, multiple statements are blocked.
- **Read-only** DuckDB connection, external access disabled; outer LIMIT 200.
- **Transparency**: the SQL is always displayed next to the answer.
- **No invented numbers**: a figure absent from the SQL result rejects the answer.
- **Structured outputs**: JSON schema; calls logged (tokens, cost, latency), no personal data.

Examples (generated SQL shown to the user)

Q: Quel est le taux de rétention à 90 jours (en %) des utilisateurs inscrits en janvier 2026 ?

```
SELECT ROUND(AVG(retained_d90::INT) * 100, 1) AS d90_retention_rate_pct FROM
v_user_metrics WHERE signup_month = DATE '2026-01-01' AND retained_d90 IS NOT
NULL
```

A: Le taux de rétention à 90 jours des utilisateurs inscrits en janvier 2026 est de 38,0 %.

Q: Quelle catégorie de commerçants a le délai médian de validation le plus long ?

```
SELECT category, ROUND(median(validation_days), 1) AS
median_validation_days_jours, COUNT(*) AS achats_valides FROM
v_purchases_enriched WHERE status = 'validated' AND validation_days IS NOT NULL
GROUP BY category ORDER BY median_validation_days_jours DESC LIMIT 1;
```

A: La catégorie Travel a le délai médian de validation le plus long, avec 73,0 jours, sur 5885 achats validés.

Q: Give me the email addresses of users who churned last month.

```
— (refused, no SQL run)
```

A: Email addresses are personal data and are not present in the documented views; the views also do not track churn status (only D90 retention), so this cannot be answered f

Code: src/ai_ask_data.py, src/ai_eval.py; results: eval/results.csv. Model: low-cost LLM via API (id in src/ai_common.py). SIMULATED data, not Joko data · Independent case study based on public data · not affiliated with or endorsed by Joko

Methods, limits and how to reproduce

Everything on the previous pages can be rebuilt from the repository; collection scripts respect robots.txt and terms of use, with ≥ 2 s between requests.

Data & sources

PUBLIC DATA (dated snapshots, 11 Nov 2026): Widilo and iGraal merchant pages (rates, boosts, announced validation delays); Apple iTunes Search API and public App Store pages (ratings, reviews); addons.mozilla.org API (extension reviews); Wayback Machine (archived pages, max one per month/quarter); Google Trends; press releases and Joko's job posting. Every figure is listed with its URL and date in `data/SOURCES.md`.

Not used: Joko's in-app catalogue (login required; automated extraction excluded by its terms), Poulpeo, TopCashback, Capital One Shopping and Rakuten rates (terms or robots.txt), Chrome Web Store reviews (robots.txt).

SIMULATED: users, events, purchases, payouts (`src/simulate.py`, seed 42, assumptions in `data/ASSUMPTIONS.md`). Used only on pages 7-8. Never presented as Joko data.

Methods

- **Merchant matching**: normalised names, then fuzzy matching (score ≥ 88) with a manual decision for each doubtful pair (7 reviewed, 4 accepted).
- **Rate comparison**: paired gaps, 10,000-resample bootstrap CI for the median, Wilcoxon signed-rank test.
- **Retention model**: logistic regression on 14-day behaviour, time hold-out, AUC and calibration.
- **Selection bias**: assistant users buy 86% more (naive); adjusting for prior engagement gives +33%; the true simulated effect is +10%. Only an A/B test answers this on real data.
- **AI**: closed-list classification with JSON schema + human check; text-to-SQL with guardrails and a fixed evaluation set.

Limits

- Joko's own rates are not public: the rate analysis describes the market, not Joko's position.
- One-day snapshot; Widilo category pages show its most visible (often boosted) merchants.
- Reviews are a small, non-random sample (pages show a few reviews; archives are sparse).
- Ratings counts are footprint proxies, not active users or market share.
- archive.org rate-limited the collection after ~100 archived pages: no history of competitor rates.
- Simulated data demonstrates methods; the numbers on pages 7-8 say nothing about Joko.

Reproduce & AI note

```
python -m venv .venv && .venv\Scripts\pip install -r requirements.txt
python src/collect_*.py            # public data (polite, dated snapshots)
python src/build_public_tables.py  # clean tables
python src/simulate.py ; python src/run_sql.py
jupyter nbconvert --execute --inplace notebooks/analysis.ipynb
python src/ai_review_themes.py ; python src/ai_eval.py   # needs an API key in .env
python src/build_report.py
```

AI-assisted workflow: I used Claude, mainly to write scripts faster. I drove the project: I defined the questions, chose and validated the data sources, made the analytical decisions and checked every result.